

Consumer Price Index Summary – May 2026

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²ABSTRACT

May 2026 CPI shows continued inflation persistence driven primarily by energy, with headline CPI at 4.2% YoY and strong gains in gasoline and fuel prices near 40% YoY. Core inflation remains lower at 2.9% YoY but is supported by sticky services, shelter, and food prices rather than broad disinflation. Price action is uneven: energy-linked categories and transportation remain elevated, while several consumer goods categories show mild contraction or stagnation. Commodities ex-energy are largely flat, indicating limited underlying goods inflation outside energy shocks. Overall, inflation remains concentrated rather than broad-based, with energy volatility keeping headline pressure elevated and core inflation sticky enough to limit policy flexibility in the near term.

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² Generated using Artificial Intelligence.

CPI Breakdown

Categorial Changes

Table 2: CPI Categories with Largest Expansion | YoY & MoM Change (May 2026)

Category	MoM %	YoY %
Gasoline	8.6	40.5
Motor Fuel	8.4	40.9
Energy Commodities	8.1	40.6
Energy	4.9	23.5
Transportation (Aggregate)	2.3	9.3
Used Cars & Trucks	1.5	-2.0
Nondurables	1.3	8.0
Electricity	1.0	5.9
Commodities (Aggregate)	1.0	5.5
All Items Less Food & Shelter	0.9	5.2

Composition

Gasoline remained the largest inflator, increasing 8.6% MoM and 40.5% YoY. Motor fuel and energy commodities followed, surging 8% MoM and 40% YoY. Transportation prices rose 2.3% MoM and 9.3% YoY, while nondurables gained 1.3% MoM and 8.0% YoY. Electricity had a slight increase of 1.0% MoM. Used cars and trucks rose 1.5% MoM, though prices remained below previous levels. Commodities continued to be robust, rising 1.0% MoM and 5.5% YoY.

Table 3: CPI Categories with Largest Contraction | YoY & MoM Change (May 2026)

Category	MoM %	YoY %
Motor Vehicle Insurance	-1.9	-2.0
Dairy & Related Products	-0.6	-1.0
Apparel	-0.4	4.8
Utility Gas Service	-0.2	3.0
Meat, Poultry, Fish & Eggs	-0.2	1.8

CPI Breakdown

Composition

While overall CPI increased, several categories weakened. Motor vehicle insurance showed a decline of 1.9% MoM and 2.0% YoY. Dairy & Related Products followed with a 0.6% MoM & 1.0% YoY fall. Apparel, Utility Gas Service, and Meat, Poultry, Fish & Eggs showed MoM declines while YoY remained elevated.

Sector Overall

Table 1: CPI Sector Inflation Components | YoY & MoM Change (May 2026)

Sector	YoY %	MoM %
Headline CPI	4.2	0.6
Core CPI	2.9	0.3
Food	3.1	0.2
Energy	23.5	4.9
Shelter	3.4	0.4
Services ³ ex Energy	3.4	0.4
Commodities ⁴ ex Food & Energy	1.1	0.0
Transportation Services	4.1	0.3
Medical Care Services	3.6	0.5

Composition

Inflation continued to accelerate throughout May 2026 as headline CPI surged 4.2% YoY & 0.6% MoM. Core CPI was much more suppressed, increasing only 2.9% annually and 0.3% from April 2026. Energy prices remained the primary driver of inflation, surging 23.5% YoY and 4.9% MoM. Food also contributed to the increase in inflation with gains of 3.1% YoY and 0.2% MoM.

³ "Ex" = Excluding Energy

⁴ "Ex" = Excluding Food & Energy

CPI Breakdown

⁵Interpretation

As I expected, CPI Inflation data showed continual increase alongside cooling labor data. Weakening the argument for rate cuts, putting downside pressure on equity indexes. I expect the same continual inflation for tomorrow's PPI data. And will be watching the feds reaction/statements next week regarding the current stance on rate hikes & cuts as well as the economy overall.

⁵ This section reflects the author's interpretation of the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Consumer Price Index Summary data (May 2026) and is not official commentary from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. Figures are based on estimated net changes in the Consumer Price Index. MoM comparisons reflect May vs April 2026. Minor discrepancies may exist due to rounding across subcomponents. All conclusions regarding the Inflation, Labor, market strength, sector rotation, and other dynamics are personal analytical inferences drawn from the reported data.